

Amazon Research Awards

AWS Agentic AI call for proposals — Spring 2026

Advancing the frontiers of AI.

By Amazon Research Awards team
| 3 min read

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About this CFP

AWS offers a broad and deep set of tools for businesses to create impactful AI solutions faster. Our mission is to share our learnings and AI capabilities as fully managed services, and put them into the hands of every scientist and developer.

AWS Agentic AI aims to advance agentic AI research by funding development of open-source tools and research that benefit the AI community at large, or impactful research related to agents.

We seek proposals related to agentic AI in the areas below:

1. Development and application of no-code / low-code solutions for agentic AI, which facilitate the rapid deployment and management of AI agents at scale
2. AI-enhanced productivity applications, which enable seamless human-AI collaboration and improve automation

3. Multi-agent systems and collaborations, which enable agents to work together securely and effectively
4. Agentic AI for accelerating scientific discovery in fields including but not limited to health & life sciences, chemistry, materials science, and physics

Other topics related to agentic AI development and applications are also welcome, including, but not limited to:

- Safety and responsible AI for agentic behavior
- Agent customization, involving post-training the execution model or optimization of prompts, tools, specs, steering files, etc. outside of the model
- Access methods for data integration and retrieval systems, e.g., vector, lexical, graph, relational, hybrid
- Enterprise-scale agent operations and governance
- Application domains, including but not limited to, software engineering, enterprise, healthcare & life sciences, finance, media & entertainment, consumer agentic assistants

Timeline

Submission period: March 25 – May 13, 2026 (11:59PM Pacific Time).

Decision letters will be sent out in August 2026.

Award details

Selected Principal Investigators (PIs) may receive the following:

- Unrestricted funds, no more than \$70,000 USD on average
- AWS Promotional Credits, no more than \$50,000 USD on average
- Training resources, including AWS tutorials and hands-on sessions with Amazon scientists and engineers

Awards are structured as one-time unrestricted gifts. The budget should include a list of expected costs specified in USD, and should not include administrative overhead costs. The final award amount will be determined by the awards panel.

Eligibility requirements

Please refer to the ARA program rules on the [rules and eligibility page](#).

Proposal requirements

Proposals for this CFP should be prepared according to the [proposal template](#) and are encouraged to be a maximum of 4 pages, not including Appendices. In addition, to submit a proposal for this CFP, please also include the following information:

1. Please describe how your research differs from or builds upon existing work in your field. What makes your findings, applications, or conceptual framework innovative or unexpected?
2. Please list the open-source tools you plan to contribute to.
3. Please list the AWS ML tools you will use.

Selection criteria

ARA will make the funding decisions based on the potential impact to the research community and the quality of the scientific content. We encourage research that uses machine learning tools, for example AWS AI/ML services (Amazon SageMaker, Amazon AI services, Amazon Bedrock).

Expectations from recipients

To the extent deemed reasonable, award recipients may acknowledge support from ARA (e.g., (“Research reported in this [publication/press release] was supported by an Amazon Research Award, [Cycle /Year].”). Award recipients will inform ARA of publications, presentations, code and data releases, blogs/social media posts, and other speaking

engagements referencing the results of the supported research or the Award. Award recipients are expected to provide updates and feedback to ARA via surveys or reports on the status of their research. Award recipients will have an opportunity to work with ARA on an informational statement about the awarded project that may be used to generate visibility for their institutions and ARA.

How to apply

When you're ready to submit your proposal, use the button below, where you'll be prompted to sign up or log in, and follow the instructions on the site.

[Submit your proposal](#)

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